

(driver enabled) such as shadow buffers and 3D textures without compromising on frame rate. The onboard 64 MB of DDR memory is capable of a total memory bandwidth of 8 GBps. The card features the proprietary ASUS Smart Doctor, which monitors the health of the card. The heat generated while benchmarking is well dissipated by the heatsink-fan combo. The card comes bundled with 3D VR glasses, with the VR circuit embedded in the graphics card itself. The packaging included a comprehensive manual, games

Price: Rs 36,000
Contact: Rashi Peripherals
Phone: 022-8260258
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.rptechindia.com

Intel Northwood 2.2 GHz Processor

Standing tall in Quake

Intel's new 2.2 GHz processor is the fastest processor as far as clock speed goes. The processor uses the latest 0.13-micron fabrication process, which enables the processor to run cooler, consume less power (the processor now runs at 1.5 V), and scale higher speeds. Another remarkable addition to this processor series is the huge, performance improving 512 KB of L2 cache. Not surprisingly, Northwood's score stood out among others. It stood tall in the *Quake III Arena* test, scoring a massive 359.2 fps in normal mode. The P4 loves gaming, as can be seen by another whopping



(*Sacrifice*, *Messiah* and *Star Trek New Worlds*) and the driver CDs. The card also came with all the necessary cables for the integrated VIVO (video in video out). Any machine slower than a 1.5 GHz will bottleneck this card.

SPECIFICATIONS:
Test machine P4 2.2 GHz, 512 MB RDRAM
Benchmarks: 7444 in 3Dmark 2001; 154.7 fps in *Evolva* benchmark (non bump-mapped); 359.2 fps (normal mode), 278.4 fps (high-end), 163.3 fps (max settings) in *Quake III*

ASUS V8200 Ti500		A-
Performance	★★★★	
Build Quality	★★★★	
Value for Money	★★★★ ^{1/2}	
Features	★★★★ ^{1/2}	
OVERALL	★★★★	

Price: \$600 (approximately Rs 28,800)
Contact: Nebula Technologies
Phone: 022-6347156
E-mail: sandip@nebulatech.com
Web site: www.intel.com

SPECIFICATIONS:
0.13-micron fabrication technology, 1.5 V core voltage, 478 Pin

Intel Northwood 2.2 GHz		A-
performance	★★★★	
Build Quality	★★★★	
Value for Money	★★★★ ^{1/2}	
Features	★★★★	
OVERALL	★★★★	



Hatim Kantawalla
Deputy Head, Test Centre

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The Intel P4 2.2 GHz is by far the fastest processor in terms of both, pure speed and performance

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IOGEAR ShareView

The two-PC simulator

This is a nifty little kit that allows you to add one more monitor to your existing machine. It can simulate two separate PCs by creating single and multi-user modes. The software even has its own messenger which allows you to message another person using the same CPU. The box came complete with an additional VGA card, the SiS 6326 PCI card. The kit included a multimedia keyboard, which had a PS2 port integrated into it for the mouse, a 15-foot USB/VGA cable, and ShareView software and drivers. The installation was easy and the system was up and running in a



short time. The price is relatively high though. The VGA card and multimedia keyboard bundled with it would not cost more than Rs 2,500, which means that the software comes at a rather high premium.

SPECIFICATIONS:
4 MB PCI VGA card, multimedia keyboard, supports Windows 95/98SE

Price: Rs 15,000
Contact: J.S. Equipment
Phone: 022-3810713/18
E-mail: jse@vsnl.com
Web site: www.iogear.com

IOGEAR ShareView		B
Performance	★★★★ ^{1/2}	
Build Quality	★★★★	
Value for Money	★★★★ ^{1/2}	
Features	★★★★	
OVERALL	★★★★	

IOMEGA Panther (16/10/40) USB 2.0

A middling performer

The IOMEGA Panther is a 16x CD-Writer and comes with the latest USB 2.0 interface. However, it did not come bundled with a USB 2.0 compliant card, which is a major drawback since very few motherboards support this relatively new standard. The drive's performance was

on par with other 16x external drives (SCSI). The writer took about 288 seconds (4 minute 48 seconds) to burn an audio CD, which is slightly on the higher side for its speed and took 488 seconds (8 minute 8 seconds) to burn assorted data on a CD-RW at 10x. The writer was a bit slow